

The $SU(2)$ bridge midpoint in closed form: the curvature term is exact

Result, 2026-09-27. Proposition 6 of the series/parallel note described the midpoint of the Brownian bridge on $SU(2)$, the building block of the non-abelian parallel insertion, only to leading order in the heat time, with the curvature factor $1/h$, $h = (d/4) \cot(d/4)$, derived by Laplace's method and labelled as asymptotics. For the fundamental character the midpoint expectation is computable exactly. For a bridge of duration t from e to a group element at geodesic distance $\theta \in (0, 2\pi)$,

$$E \chi_{1/2}(m) = e^{-t/32} \left[2 \cos \frac{\theta}{4} - \frac{t}{2\theta} \sin \frac{\theta}{4} \right] \text{ up to image terms of relative size } \left(2 + \frac{32\pi^2}{t} \right) e^{-4\pi(2\pi-\theta)/t}$$

(Theorem 1). Expanded to first order it is exactly the prediction of Proposition 6(b), $2 \cos \frac{\theta}{4} [1 - \frac{t}{32} (1 + \frac{2}{h(\theta)})]$, because $\frac{t}{32} \cdot \frac{2}{h} = \frac{t}{4\theta} \tan \frac{\theta}{4}$. So the curvature term N2, the side-flux-dependent softening of the mid-face weight, is confirmed with no remainder of order t^2 in the $w = 0$ sector: the only correction to the displayed formula is the exponentially small winding of the bridge around the group. This is the first exact non-abelian statement about the parallel insertion in three dimensions, and it settles the fundamental-representation part of the uniform Laplace remainder that Proposition 7 of the series/parallel note assumes, for the trace in the fundamental representation (the image terms are of the stated order, and not uniformly so as $\theta \rightarrow 2\pi$).

The ingredients are character orthogonality and Poisson summation; the computation is elementary and no novelty is claimed for it.

1. Setting

Group metric as in the series/parallel note §1: $C_2(j) = j(j+1)$, $SU(2)$ the three-sphere of radius 2, heat kernel $k_t = \sum_j (2j+1) e^{-tj(j+1)/2} \chi_j$ with $\chi_j(\theta) = \sin((2j+1)\theta/2) / \sin(\theta/2)$ at rotation angle θ (the geodesic distance from e). The midpoint m of the bridge of duration t from e to g has density $k_{t/2}(m) k_{t/2}(m^{-1}g) / k_t(g)$ with respect to Haar measure. Its geodesic midpoint $m_* = \exp(\frac{1}{2} \log g)$ has rotation angle $\theta/2$, so $\chi_{1/2}(m_*) = \sin(\theta/2) / \sin(\theta/4) = 2 \cos(\theta/4)$.

2. The exact formula

Theorem 1. Put $\Theta_{\pm}(\theta) = \sum_{w \in \mathbb{Z}} (\pm 1)^w e^{-(\theta - 4\pi w)^2 / (2t)}$ and $\Xi_{\pm}(\theta) = \sum_{w \in \mathbb{Z}} (\pm 1)^w (\theta - 4\pi w) e^{-(\theta - 4\pi w)^2 / (2t)}$. For $\theta \in (0, 2\pi)$,

$$E \chi_{1/2}(m) = e^{-t/32} \frac{2 \cos(\theta/4) \Xi_{-}(\theta) - \frac{t}{2} \sin(\theta/4) \Theta_{-}(\theta)}{\Xi_{+}(\theta)}. \quad (1)$$

Keeping only $w = 0$ gives the displayed formula of the summary.

Proof. Expand both heat kernels in characters. Character orthogonality in the form $\int \chi_a(m) \chi_b(m^{-1}g) dm = \delta_{ab} \chi_a(g) / d_a$, together with $\chi_{j_1} \chi_{1/2} = \chi_{j_1+1/2} + \chi_{j_1-1/2}$, gives

$$k_t(g) E \chi_{1/2}(m) = \sum_{j_1} \sum_{j_2=j_1 \pm 1/2} (2j_1+1) e^{-t[C_2(j_1)+C_2(j_2)]/4} \chi_{j_2}(g).$$

Write $n = 2j_1 + 1$. Then $C_2(j_1) + C_2(j_2) = \frac{1}{4}[n^2 + (n \pm 1)^2 - 2] = \frac{1}{2}(n \pm \frac{1}{2})^2 - \frac{3}{8}$, so the exponential is $e^{3t/32} e^{-t(n \pm 1/2)^2/8}$. Multiply by $\sin(\theta/2)$, reindex the $j_2 = j_1 - \frac{1}{2}$ sum by $n \mapsto n+1$, and write $s = n + \frac{1}{2}$ over $s \in \frac{1}{2} + \mathbb{N}$: the summand becomes $(s - \frac{1}{2}) \sin \frac{(s+\frac{1}{2})\theta}{2} + (s + \frac{1}{2}) \sin \frac{(s-\frac{1}{2})\theta}{2} = 2s \cos \frac{\theta}{4} \sin \frac{s\theta}{2} - \sin \frac{\theta}{4} \cos \frac{s\theta}{2}$, which is even in s . Hence

$$k_t(g) \sin \frac{\theta}{2} E \chi_{1/2}(m) = \frac{e^{3t/32}}{2} \left[2 \cos \frac{\theta}{4} A - \sin \frac{\theta}{4} B \right],$$

with $B = \sum_{s \in \frac{1}{2} + \mathbb{Z}} e^{-ts^2/8} \cos \frac{s\theta}{2}$ and $A = \sum_{s \in \frac{1}{2} + \mathbb{Z}} s e^{-ts^2/8} \sin \frac{s\theta}{2} = -2\partial_\theta B$. In the same way $k_t(g) \sin \frac{\theta}{2} = \frac{e^{t/8}}{2} A_0$ with $A_0 = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} n e^{-tn^2/8} \sin \frac{n\theta}{2}$. Poisson summation over the half-integers (which introduces the sign $(-1)^w$) and over the integers gives $B = \sqrt{8\pi/t} \Theta_-$, $A = (2/t) \sqrt{8\pi/t} \Xi_-$ and $A_0 = (2/t) \sqrt{8\pi/t} \Xi_+$. Divide. $\square$

The image terms. For $\theta \in (0, 2\pi)$ the pair $w = \pm 1$ in $\Xi_\pm$ has, relative to the $w = 0$ term $\theta e^{-\theta^2/(2t)}$, the size $e^{-8\pi^2/t} |2\theta \cosh(4\pi\theta/t) - 8\pi \sinh(4\pi\theta/t)|/\theta \leq (2 + 32\pi^2/t) e^{-4\pi(2\pi-\theta)/t}$, using $\sinh x \leq x \cosh x$. In Θ_- the same pair has relative size at most $2e^{-4\pi(2\pi-\theta)/t}$. The pairs $|w| \geq 2$ are smaller by a further factor $e^{-16\pi^2/t}$ up to polynomial factors. This is the large-field term N4, the winding of the bridge around the group, and it is negligible uniformly on $\theta \leq \theta_0 < 2\pi$.

3. Comparison with Proposition 6

Proposition 6(b) predicts that $m = m_* e^\xi$ with ξ Gaussian of mean zero and co-variance $\frac{t}{4} \text{diag}(1, \frac{1}{h}, \frac{1}{h})$ in the frame (axis, transverse). In the spin- $\frac{1}{2}$ representation $(\xi \cdot T)^2 = -\frac{1}{4} |\xi|^2$, so $E D^{1/2}(e^\xi) = 1 - \frac{1}{8} E |\xi|^2 + O(t^2) = 1 - \frac{t}{32} (1 + \frac{2}{h}) + O(t^2)$, and $E \chi_{1/2}(m) = 2 \cos \frac{\theta}{4} [1 - \frac{t}{32} (1 + \frac{2}{h})] + O(t^2)$. The $w = 0$ part of (1) equals $2 \cos \frac{\theta}{4} e^{-t/32} [1 - \frac{t}{4\theta} \tan \frac{\theta}{4}]$, and $\frac{t}{32} \cdot \frac{2}{h(\theta)} = \frac{t}{16} \cdot \frac{\tan(\theta/4)}{\theta/4} = \frac{t}{4\theta} \tan \frac{\theta}{4}$. The two agree at first order, curvature factor included. As $\theta \rightarrow 0$ both give $2(1 - \frac{3t}{32})$, the flat value $E |\xi|^2 = \frac{3t}{4}$.

Formula (1) says more than the asymptotics. In the $w = 0$ sector the fundamental character of the midpoint is the product of an isotropic factor $e^{-t/32}$ and the exactly linear curvature correction $1 - \frac{t}{4\theta} \tan \frac{\theta}{4}$; there are no higher-order terms in t . The correction grows as $\theta \rightarrow 2\pi$, where $\tan(\theta/4)$ diverges and the midpoint becomes bimodal, and there the image terms take over. This is the non-abelian counterpart of the parity factor $\rho_t(\phi)$ of the $U(1)$ cube (Proposition 3 of the series/parallel note).

4. Every spin

Theorem 2. For every spin J and $\theta \in (0, 2\pi)$, with $\sigma = 0$ for integer J and $\sigma = \frac{1}{2}$ for half-integer J ,

$$E \chi_J(m) = \frac{\Xi_{(\sigma)}(\theta)}{\Xi_+(\theta)} \sum_{k=-J}^J e^{-tk^2/8} \cos \frac{k\theta}{2} - \frac{t}{2} \frac{\Theta_{(\sigma)}(\theta)}{\Xi_+(\theta)} \sum_{k=-J}^J k e^{-tk^2/8} \sin \frac{k\theta}{2},$$

where $\Xi_{(0)} = \Xi_+$, $\Theta_{(0)} = \Theta_+$, $\Xi_{(1/2)} = \Xi_-$, $\Theta_{(1/2)} = \Theta_-$, and k runs in unit steps. In the $w = 0$ sector,

$$E \chi_J(m) = \sum_{k=-J}^J e^{-tk^2/8} \left[\cos \frac{k\theta}{2} - \frac{t}{2\theta} k \sin \frac{k\theta}{2} \right]. \quad (2)$$

For integer J the first ratio is exactly one, image terms included.

Proof. As for Theorem 1, now with $\chi_{j_1} \chi_J = \sum_{k=-J}^J \chi_{j_1+k}$. This identity holds for every j_1 if χ_j is defined by $\sin((2j+1)\theta/2)/\sin(\theta/2)$ also for $2j+1 \leq 0$: it is the product-to-sum formula for $\sin(n\theta/2) \sum_k e^{ik\theta}$. The formal terms with $2j_2+1 \leq 0$ cancel in pairs carrying the same weight, so the sum may be taken over all $n = 2j_1+1 \in \mathbb{Z}$, halved; the summand is even under $(n, k) \mapsto (-n, -k)$. With $n_2 = n + 2k$, $C_2(j_1) + C_2(j_2) = \frac{1}{2}(n+k)^2 + \frac{1}{2}(k^2-1)$, so the weight is $e^{t/8} e^{-tk^2/8} e^{-ts^2/8}$ with $s = n+k \in \mathbb{Z} + \sigma$. Expanding $(s-k) \sin \frac{(s+k)\theta}{2}$ and discarding the terms odd in s leaves $\cos \frac{k\theta}{2} \cdot s \sin \frac{s\theta}{2} - k \sin \frac{k\theta}{2} \cos \frac{s\theta}{2}$. Summing over s gives A_σ and B_σ ,

Poisson summation gives $\Xi_{(\sigma)}$ and $\Theta_{(\sigma)}$, and the factor $e^{t/8}$ cancels against the denominator. For $J = \frac{1}{2}$ this is Theorem 1. $\square$

Agreement with Proposition 6 for every spin. The leading term of (2) is $\sum_k \cos(k\theta/2) = \chi_J(m_*)$, the character at the geodesic midpoint (rotation angle $\theta/2$). The Gaussian prediction of Proposition 6(b) at first order is $\sum_k \cos \frac{k\theta}{2} [1 - \frac{t}{8}k^2 - \frac{t}{8}(J(J+1) - k^2)/h]$ with $1/h = 4 \tan(\theta/4)/\theta$. The two agree iff, with $\varphi = \theta/2$,

$$\sum_k k \sin(k\varphi) = \tan \frac{\varphi}{2} \sum_k (J(J+1) - k^2) \cos(k\varphi).$$

The left side is $-\chi'_J(\varphi)$ and the sum on the right is $J(J+1)\chi_J + \chi''_J$. The class-function Laplacian of $SU(2)$ in this metric gives $\chi''_J + \cot(\varphi/2)\chi'_J = -J(J+1)\chi_J$, which is the identity. (For $J = \frac{1}{2}$ and $J = 1$ it can be checked directly: $\sin(\varphi/2) = \tan(\varphi/2)\cos(\varphi/2)$ and $2\sin\varphi = \tan(\varphi/2)(2 + 2\cos\varphi)$.) So the curvature term of Proposition 6 is exact at first order in every representation, and (2) contains no terms of order t^2 beyond the Gaussian factors $e^{-tk^2/8}$.

What the trace does not give. By Proposition 6(a), $ED^J(m) = D^J(m_*)\Lambda^J$ with Λ^J real diagonal in the axis basis, and (2) fixes only $\sum_\mu e^{i\mu\theta/2}\Lambda_{\mu\mu}^J$, one equation for $2J+1$ entries. The isolated cube needs the entries, because its four cut faces have different axes.

5. The fundamental sector of the isolated cube is exact

Theorem 3. (a) In spin $\frac{1}{2}$ the midpoint's matrix expectation is a real multiple of a unitary: $ED^{1/2}(m) = \lambda(\theta, t) D^{1/2}(m_*)$ with

$$\lambda(\theta, t) = e^{-t/32} \frac{\Xi_-(\theta) - \frac{t}{4} \tan \frac{\theta}{4} \Theta_-(\theta)}{\Xi_+(\theta)} \stackrel{w=0}{=} e^{-t/32} \left[1 - \frac{t}{4\theta} \tan \frac{\theta}{4} \right], \quad \theta \in (0, 2\pi).$$

(b) For one refined cube (series/parallel note, §4), whose four cut side faces have heat times t_j and side angles θ_j , the spin- $\frac{1}{2}$ term of the character sum for Ψ is exactly

$$d_{1/2} e^{-3tm/8} \text{tr}_{1/2} \prod_j ED^{1/2}(m_j^{\pm 1}) = 2 e^{-3tm/8} \left(\prod_{j=1}^4 \lambda(\theta_j, t_j) \right) \chi_{1/2}(h_{\text{int}}),$$

where h_{int} is the holonomy of the geodesic interpolation around the mid-face. In this sector the interpolation term N1 is exact (it is h_{int}), the curvature term N2 is exact (it is $\prod \lambda$), and the commutator term N3 vanishes.

Proof. (a) By Proposition 6(a) of the series/parallel note, $ED^{1/2}(m) = D^{1/2}(m_*)\Lambda$ with $\Lambda = \text{diag}(\Lambda_+, \Lambda_-)$ real in the axis basis, where $D^{1/2}(m_*) = \text{diag}(e^{i\theta/4}, e^{-i\theta/4})$. Its trace $e^{i\theta/4}\Lambda_{++} + e^{-i\theta/4}\Lambda_{--}$ equals $E\chi_{1/2}(m)$, which is real because the midpoint density and $\chi_{1/2}$ are real. The imaginary part gives $\sin(\theta/4)(\Lambda_+ - \Lambda_-) = 0$, so $\Lambda_+ = \Lambda_- = \lambda$, and $\lambda = E\chi_{1/2}(m)/(2\cos(\theta/4))$ by Theorem 1. (b) The bridge for a cut face runs from Q_j^{-1} to P_j ; left translation by Q_j^{-1} maps it to a bridge from e , so $ED^{1/2}(m_j) = \lambda_j D^{1/2}(m_{*j})$ with m_{*j} the geodesic midpoint, and $ED^{1/2}(m_j^{-1}) = \lambda_j D^{1/2}(m_{*j})^{-1}$ because λ_j is real. The four midpoints are independent, since each is fixed by its own cut face and an isolated cube has no shared mid-edges, so the trace of the product of expectations is $\prod_j \lambda_j$ times the trace of the product of the unitaries, which is $\chi_{1/2}(h_{\text{int}})$. The prefactor is $d_{1/2} e^{-tmC_2(1/2)/2}$ with $C_2(\frac{1}{2}) = \frac{3}{4}$. $\square$

For $J \geq 1$ the diagonal entries differ: the Gaussian prediction is $\Lambda_{\mu\mu}^J \simeq 1 - \frac{t}{8}[\mu^2 + (J(J+1) - \mu^2)/h]$, which depends on μ unless $h = 1$. The Weyl reflection combined with time reversal gives $\Lambda_{\mu\mu}^J = \Lambda_{-\mu, -\mu}^J$ for every J : with w in the normaliser of the torus, $\text{Ad}(w)X = -X$, the map $g \mapsto e^X w g w^{-1}$ carries the bridge from e to e^X to the bridge from e^X to e , whose midpoint law is the same by reversibility, and conjugation by $D(w)$ exchanges μ and $-\mu$ on a diagonal

matrix (reviewer's argument; the reality of the trace alone gives only one relation). The trace (2) then fixes $\lfloor J \rfloor + 1$ unknowns by one equation, so for $J = 1$ one relation remains between Λ_{11}^1 and Λ_{00}^1 . The matrix-element version of the orthogonality computation of Theorem 1, with the Clebsch–Gordan coefficients of $j_1 \otimes J$, is the tool for them.

6. The spin-1 matrix and isolated cube

Theorem 4 (2026-09-27, GPT-6 Astra; refereed by Fable the same day, all fifteen items verified by hand, no errors). Notation of this section: E in the image bounds, A_0 , A_1 , $B(x)$ and P_j are local to Theorem 4 and differ from the quantities of the same names in Theorems 1 and 3. The spin-1 midpoint matrix is exactly determined by two real entries $\lambda_0 = \Lambda_{00}^1$ and $\lambda_1 = \Lambda_{11}^1 = \Lambda_{-1,-1}^1$. The formulas below give both entries, including winding, for every $t > 0$ and $0 < \theta < 2\pi$. They involve a Gaussian tail, which retains higher-order curvature corrections beyond the character formula.

Put $x = \theta/2$, $\eta = e^{t/8}$, and define

$$G_t(z) = e^{-2z^2/t}, \quad T_t(z) = \int_z^\infty (1 - \eta \cos u) e^{-2u^2/t} du, \quad S_t(x) = \sum_{w \in \mathbb{Z}} T_t(x - 2\pi w). \quad (3)$$

The Gaussian integral of $1 - \eta \cos u$ over the real line is zero; thus T_t is odd and decays at both ends. In particular the image sum in (3) is absolutely convergent. A special-function closed form is

$$T_t(z) = \sqrt{\frac{\pi t}{8}} \left[\operatorname{erfc} \left(\sqrt{\frac{2}{t}} z \right) - \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{erfc} \left(\sqrt{\frac{2}{t}} z - i \sqrt{\frac{t}{8}} \right) \right]. \quad (4)$$

With $\Theta = \Theta_+(\theta)$ and $\Xi = \Xi_+(\theta)$ of Theorem 1,

$$\lambda_0 = 1 + \frac{t\eta^{-1}}{\sin x \Xi} [(\eta \cos x - 1)\Theta - \cot x S_t(x)], \quad (5)$$

$$\lambda_1 = \eta^{-1} \left\{ 1 - \frac{t}{2 \sin x \Xi} \left[(\eta - \cos x)\Theta - \frac{S_t(x)}{\sin x} \right] \right\}. \quad (6)$$

These expressions are regular at $\theta = \pi$. The endpoint $\theta = 0$ is obtained by continuity and has $\lambda_0 = \lambda_1$ by conjugation invariance. The denominator Ξ is positive on the stated open interval, since it is proportional to $k_t(g) \sin x$.

Matrix-element computation. Write $c_{a,b}(\alpha, \mu) = |\langle a\alpha; 1\mu \mid b, \alpha + \mu \rangle|^2$. The spin-1 Clebsch–Gordan squares are

b	$c_{a,b}(\alpha, 0)$	$c_{a,b}(\alpha, 1)$
$a + 1$	$\frac{(a+1)^2 - \alpha^2}{(a+1)(2a+1)}$	$\frac{(a+\alpha+1)(a+\alpha+2)}{2(a+1)(2a+1)}$
a	$\frac{\alpha^2}{a(a+1)}$	$\frac{(a-\alpha)(a+\alpha+1)}{2a(a+1)}$
$a - 1$	$\frac{a^2 - \alpha^2}{a(2a+1)}$	$\frac{(a-\alpha)(a-\alpha-1)}{2a(2a+1)}$

Here $c_{a,b}(\alpha, -1) = c_{a,b}(-\alpha, 1)$, and only actual summands of $a \otimes 1$ are included: $a = 0$ has just $b = 1$, and $a = 1/2$ has $b = 1/2, 3/2$. These squares follow by lowering the highest vector of spin $a + 1$ and taking the orthogonal spin- a and spin- $(a - 1)$ vectors at each total weight.

The lowering rule used is $J_-|a, \alpha\rangle = \sqrt{(a+\alpha)(a-\alpha+1)}|a, \alpha-1\rangle$; normalization gives the denominators in the table.

Matrix-element orthogonality gives, with $C_a = a(a+1)$,

$$k_t(g)E[D^1(m)]_{\mu\mu} = \sum_{a,b} (2a+1)e^{-t(C_a+C_b)/4} \sum_{\alpha=-a}^a c_{a,b}(\alpha, \mu) e^{i(\alpha+\mu)\theta}. \quad (7)$$

The factor $2b+1$ in the second heat kernel cancels its orthogonality denominator. For $\mu = 0$, put $N_0 = k_t(g)\lambda_0$ and

$$B(x) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} e^{-tn^2/8} \cos(nx), \quad H(x) = \sum_{n \neq 0} e^{-tn^2/8} \frac{\sin(nx)}{n}, \quad H(x) = \int_0^x (B(y) - 1) dy.$$

We compute the $b = a \pm 1$ and $b = a$ parts of (7) separately. In the first two parts multiplication by α^2 becomes $-\partial_\theta^2$. Write $n = 2a + 1$ and shift to $s = n \pm 1$; the common heat weight is $e^{-ts^2/8}$. Combining the two parts gives

$$\begin{aligned} N_{\text{off}} &= \sum_{s \geq 1} e^{-ts^2/8} \left(s + \frac{1}{s} \partial_x^2 \right) [\cot x \sin(sx)] \\ &= \frac{\cot x H(x) - B(x) + 1}{\sin^2 x}. \end{aligned} \quad (8)$$

The formal lower-spin term at $a = 1/2$ vanishes because $(a^2 + \partial_\theta^2)\chi_a = 0$; the missing upper partner at $s = 1$ has $\sin((s-1)x) = 0$. This accounts for the endpoints of the reindexing. The cancellation in (8) follows directly from

$$\partial_x^2 [\cot x \sin(sx)] = 2 \csc^2 x \cot x \sin(sx) - 2s \csc^2 x \cos(sx) - s^2 \cot x \sin(sx).$$

For the diagonal coupling $b = a$, set $f_n(x) = \sin(nx)/\sin x$. Its elementary differential identity is $f_n'' + 2 \cot x f_n' = -(n^2 - 1)f_n$. Hence

$$N_{\text{diag}} = k_t(g) - 1 + 2\eta \cot x \left(\frac{V(x)}{\sin x} \right)', \quad V(x) = \sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{ne^{-tn^2/8}}{n^2 - 1} \sin(nx).$$

The omitted $n = 1$ term in the heat kernel is exactly 1. Moreover, $V'' + V = B'/2 + \eta^{-1} \sin x$ and $V(0) = 0$, so the Wronskian identity gives

$$\left(\frac{V}{\sin x} \right)' = \frac{1}{\sin^2 x} \int_0^x \sin y \left(\frac{B'(y)}{2} + \eta^{-1} \sin y \right) dy.$$

Adding (8), integrating $\sin y B'(y)$ once, and using $2 \int_0^x \sin^2 y dy = x - \sin x \cos x$ yields

$$N_0 = k_t(g) + \frac{1}{\sin^2 x} \left[(\eta \cos x - 1)B(x) + \cot x \int_0^x (1 - \eta \cos y)B(y) dy \right]. \quad (9)$$

Every series above and its displayed derivatives converge absolutely for $t > 0$. Poisson summation, with the normalization of Theorem 1, gives

$$B(x) = \sqrt{\frac{8\pi}{t}} \sum_w G_t(x - 2\pi w), \quad k_t(g) = \frac{\eta}{t \sin x} \sqrt{\frac{8\pi}{t}} \Xi.$$

Periodicity of the cosine and oddness of T_t give

$$\int_0^x (1 - \eta \cos y)B(y) dy = -\sqrt{\frac{8\pi}{t}} S_t(x) :$$

the integration constants are $\sum_w T_t(-2\pi w) = 0$, paired in w . Substitution into (9) proves (5).

Weyl reflection with time reversal, as proved in §5, gives $\Lambda_{11}^1 = \Lambda_{-1,-1}^1$. Theorem 2 therefore reads

$$\lambda_0 + 2 \cos x \lambda_1 = 1 + 2\eta^{-1} \cos x - t\eta^{-1} \sin x \frac{\Theta}{\Xi}. \quad (10)$$

Inserting (5), the numerator for $2 \cos x \lambda_1$ factors by $\cos x$, giving (6). This first proves (6) when $\cos x \neq 0$; continuity proves it also at $x = \pi/2$. Here (6) is obtained from (5) through (10), and (10) itself follows from (7) because $\sum_\mu c_{a,b}(m - \mu, \mu) = 1$; so the trace is a consistency of the framework. Reality and the equality of the opposite weights are explicit. $\square$

Independent check through the $\mu = 1$ column (Fable referee, 2026-09-27). Reducing (7) directly at $\mu = 1$, with total weight m , $p = 2m$ and $q = p - 1$: the $b = a \pm 1$ parts combine to the summand $(s+p)(s+p-2) + (s-p)(s-p+2) = 2s^2 + 2q^2 - 2$, where q runs over the weights of spin $(s-1)/2$, so the off-diagonal part is $\sum_{s \geq 1} (e^{-ts^2/8}/s)[(s^2-1)f_s + \cot x f'_s]$ with f_s the character sum of spin $(s-1)/2$; the diagonal part has bracket $2f'_n(i - \cot x) = -2f'_n e^{-ix}/\sin x$. Assembling with $H' = B - 1$ and the Wronskian of the diagonal step reproduces (6) exactly. Since (6) was derived from (5) and (10), this confirms (5) as well. (Before (9), the -1 of the diagonal part is absorbed by $1 - \cos^2 x = \sin^2 x$.) At first order $\lambda_0 - \lambda_1 = -\frac{t}{8}(\frac{1}{h} - 1) < 0$, since $h < 1$ on $0 < \theta < 2\pi$.

The zero image and explicit image bounds. Define $R_t(x) = e^{2x^2/t} T_t(x)$ and

$$A_0 = \eta \cos x - 1 - \cot x R_t(x), \quad A_1 = \eta - \cos x - \frac{R_t(x)}{\sin x}.$$

Keeping $w = 0$ in both numerator and denominator of (5)–(6) gives

$$\lambda_0^{(0)} = 1 + \frac{t\eta^{-1}}{\theta \sin x} A_0, \quad \lambda_1^{(0)} = \eta^{-1} \left[1 - \frac{t}{2\theta \sin x} A_1 \right]. \quad (11)$$

For explicit bounds on all remaining images, put

$$q = e^{-4\pi(2\pi-\theta)/t}, \quad r = e^{-16\pi^2/t}, \quad E = \frac{2q}{1-r},$$

$$\delta = q \left[\frac{2}{1-r} + \frac{32\pi^2}{t} \frac{1+r}{(1-r)^3} \right], \quad M = \frac{(1+\eta)t}{4(2\pi-x)}.$$

Whenever $\delta < 1$,

$$|\lambda_0 - \lambda_0^{(0)}| \leq \frac{t\eta^{-1}}{\theta \sin x(1-\delta)} \{E[|\eta \cos x - 1| + |\cot x| M] + \delta |A_0|\}, \quad (12)$$

$$|\lambda_1 - \lambda_1^{(0)}| \leq \frac{t\eta^{-1}}{2\theta \sin x(1-\delta)} \left\{ E \left[\eta - \cos x + \frac{M}{\sin x} \right] + \delta |A_1| \right\}. \quad (13)$$

To verify these bounds, write $G = G_t(x)$. The pair $w = \pm n$ has Gaussian ratio bounded by $2q_n$, where $q_n = e^{-8\pi^2 n^2/t + 8\pi n x/t} \leq q r^{n-1}$. Its contribution to $\Xi/(\theta G) - 1$ is at most $(2 + 32\pi^2 n^2/t)q_n$, by the same $\sinh u \leq u \cosh u$ estimate as in Theorem 1. Consequently

$$\left| \frac{\Theta}{G} - 1 \right| \leq E, \quad \left| \frac{\Xi}{\theta G} - 1 \right| \leq \delta.$$

For $z \neq 0$, oddness and the Gaussian tail bound give

$$|T_t(z)| \leq (1+\eta) \int_{|z|}^{\infty} G_t(u) du \leq \frac{(1+\eta)t}{4|z|} G_t(z).$$

All nonzero images have $|x - 2\pi w| \geq 2\pi - x$, whence $|S_t(x)/G - R_t(x)| \leq ME$. Dividing by $\Xi/(\theta G)$ proves (12)–(13), including the denominator error. The formulas (5)–(6) hold at all $t > 0$; the explicit small-image estimates require the displayed condition $\delta < 1$. They are exponentially small uniformly on each compact subinterval of $0 < \theta < 2\pi$ as $t \downarrow 0$. Their displayed prefactors become loose at $\theta = 0$, where the exact expressions have removable singularities; their exponential separation degenerates at the cut locus $\theta = 2\pi$.

Gaussian and central-endpoint checks. Integration by parts in (3), at fixed $x > 0$, gives

$$R_t(x) = \frac{t}{4x}(1 - \eta \cos x) + O_x(t^2).$$

Thus, with $h = (x/2) \cot(x/2)$,

$$\lambda_0 = 1 - \frac{t}{4h} + O_\theta(t^2), \quad \lambda_1 = 1 - \frac{t}{8} \left(1 + \frac{1}{h}\right) + O_\theta(t^2). \quad (14)$$

Here the exponentially small image errors are absorbed into the remainder. This is exactly $1 - \frac{t}{8}[\mu^2 + (2 - \mu^2)/h]$ for $\mu = 0, \pm 1$. At $\theta = 0$, conjugation invariance and (10) give the independent check

$$\lambda_0(0, t) = \lambda_1(0, t) = \frac{1}{3} \left[1 + 2\eta^{-1} - \frac{t\eta^{-1}}{2} \frac{\Theta_+(0)}{\partial_\theta \Xi_+(0)} \right].$$

The zero-image limit of either expression (11) is $[1 + 2\eta^{-1} - (t/2)\eta^{-1}]/3 = 1 - t/4 + O(t^2)$, in agreement with $h(0) = 1$.

Consequence for the isolated cube. For cut face j , denote the bridge endpoints by A_j, B_j , put $X_j = \log(A_j^{-1}B_j)$, and set $m_{*j} = A_j e^{X_j/2}$. Let P_j project onto weight zero along X_j in spin 1. In the three-dimensional vector realization it is the rank-one projector $\hat{X}_j \hat{X}_j^\top$. With (5)–(6) at (θ_j, t_j) , put

$$L_j = \lambda_{1j}I + (\lambda_{0j} - \lambda_{1j})P_j, \quad U_j = D^1(m_{*j}), \quad F_j^+ = U_j L_j, \quad F_j^- = L_j U_j^{-1}.$$

The four independent bridges of one isolated cube give its exact spin-1 contribution to Ψ :

$$\boxed{\Psi_1 = 3e^{-t_m} \text{tr}_1 (F_1^{\varepsilon_1} F_2^{\varepsilon_2} F_3^{\varepsilon_3} F_4^{\varepsilon_4}), \quad \varepsilon_j \in \{+, -\}}, \quad (15)$$

in the boundary order and orientations of the mid-face. The exponent is $-t_m C_2(1)/2 = -t_m$. Left translation reduces each bridge to (5)–(6); inversion takes the adjoint and explains the order in F_j^- . The independence is the same isolated-cube hypothesis as in Theorem 3.

This sector retains an exact anisotropy $\lambda_0 - \lambda_1 = (t/8)(1 - 1/h) + O_\theta(t^2)$. After transporting axes to a common frame, two such factors obey

$$[L_i, L_j] = (\lambda_{0i} - \lambda_{1i})(\lambda_{0j} - \lambda_{1j})[P_i, P_j], \quad \|[P_i, P_j]\| = |c| \sqrt{1 - c^2} \leq \frac{1}{2},$$

where c is the scalar product of the transported unit axes. Consequently the axis-dependent matrix product in (15) supplies the spin-1 noncommuting correction explicitly; generic oblique axes give a commutator of order $t_i t_j$ at fixed nonzero side angles. The scalar factorization of Theorem 3 is special to spin 1/2.

For an explicit winding bound on (15), let ϵ_j be the maximum of the right sides of (12)–(13) for face j , assuming each $\delta_j < 1$, and replace each L_j by its zero-image value to obtain $\Psi_1^{(0)}$. Since an expectation of unitary matrices has norm at most 1, telescoping the four products gives

$$|\Psi_1 - \Psi_1^{(0)}| \leq 9e^{-t_m} \left[\prod_{j=1}^4 (1 + \epsilon_j) - 1 \right]. \quad (16)$$

The factor 9 is the character coefficient 3 times the trace-norm bound $|\text{tr}_1 A| \leq 3\|A\|$.

7. Consequence for STATE

Atlas cell 1 is filled through spin 1 by Theorem 4, with exact matrix entries, explicit image bounds and the isolated-cube contribution. For $J > 1$, (7) with the spin- J Clebsch–Gordan squares is still an exact spectral representation. The finite Gaussian-tail reduction and its bounds have been completed here for $J = 1$; the higher-spin entries and estimates permitting the full character sum remain the next obligation before the isolated-cube Laplace claim of Proposition 7. The full mid-plane and iteration remain the subsequent atlas cells.